CASE STUDY

Fuds International — 0→1 Digital Platform

Type: Built & Shipped

Domain: E-Commerce · Home Services

Status: Live

Built & Shipped | E-Commerce · Home Services | Product Portfolio | Fuds

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TL;DR

> *A 10-year-old offline security business had zero digital presence and a broken operations process. I built both the customer-facing Shopify website and an internal booking system together — because solving one without the other would have failed. Result: 3.5× lead growth, 60% conversion, 40% retention.*

The Problem

Fuds International had been operating since 2013 — 2,500+ completed projects, 3,000+ clients, strong offline reputation. But the business was entirely invisible online.

How customers found them before:

- Word of mouth
- JustDial listings (no pricing, no trust signals, phone-only)
- Referrals from existing clients

What this meant in practice:

- No inbound digital channel
- Sales team dependent on outbound calls
- No pricing transparency — every lead required a full phone consultation
- Zero data on customer acquisition or conversion

When I mapped the full customer journey — from "someone searches for CCTV installation in Mumbai" to "technician completes the job" — I found **two distinct failure points, not one:**

FAILURE POINT	PROBLEM	IMPACT
Acquisition	No digital presence	Invisible to high-intent customers
Operations	30+ min manual coordination per order	Poor first impression post-inquiry

The key insight: **fixing acquisition without fixing operations would have made things worse.** More leads hitting a broken process = more frustrated customers = lower conversion and retention.

My Role

End-to-end product ownership in an 8-person company with no dedicated design, no analytics infrastructure, and a tight budget.

- Product strategy and roadmap definition
- Figma wireframes (designed myself)

- Information architecture across all service lines
- User research: interviews + heatmap analysis
- Google Analytics setup and funnel tracking
- Shopify build coordination with one developer
- PRD writing using 8-section framework

User Research

Conducted user interviews and heatmap analysis to understand conversion barriers. The finding was consistent across all interviews:

> ***Trust was the #1 conversion barrier — not price, not availability.***

In a category where you're letting a stranger into your home to install security equipment, customers needed to know: Who is this company? Are they legitimate? Are these technicians verified?

Competitors on JustDial provided none of this. No pricing. No credentials. No project history. Just a phone number.

Secondary finding: Mobile users were dropping off at a specific point in the booking form — the date-picker. 38% of users who started the form never completed it, and GA showed this was concentrated at one step.

Market Analysis

SEGMENT	DESCRIPTION	OPPORTUNITY
Primary	Mumbai homeowners, SMBs needing CCTV/access control	High intent, low-trust environment
Secondary	Corporate offices, housing societies	Bulk orders, repeat relationships
Competitor gap	JustDial-listed unorganised installers	No digital-first, price-transparent competitor

Key competitive insight: No competitor in the Mumbai home security installation market showed pricing upfront. This became the central differentiator.

Prioritisation (RICE)

FEATURE	REACH	IMPACT	CONFIDENCE	EFFORT	SCORE
Upfront pricing on listings	High	High	High	Low	★★★★★
Trust signals (badges, logos)	High	High	High	Low	★★★★★
Book a Meet flow	High	High	Medium	Medium	★★★★
Mobile form optimisation	Medium	High	High	Low	★★★★
SEO-informed catalogue	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	★★★

What I Built

Product 1 — Shopify Website

Information architecture:

- 7 service lines: CCTV, AV Solutions, Access Control, WiFi/Networking, Intercom/EPABX, Video Door Phone, Home Automation
- 10+ product categories
- 9 brand partners: CP Plus, Honeywell, HID, Aruba, D-Link, Matrix, Vivotek, KNX, HK Vision

Key product decisions:

1. **Upfront pricing on every listing** — DVR/NVR Installation from ₹749, Access Controller from ₹1,499. No competitor showed pricing. This became the single biggest conversion driver because customers arrived pre-qualified.
2. **Trust signals as a product feature** — 2,500+ projects badge, brand partner logos, Aadhaar-verified technician credentials on service pages. Not decoration — engineered specifically to answer the #1 conversion barrier surfaced in research.
3. **'Book a Meet' appointment flow** — replaced the phone-call-only model with a structured booking form creating the first inbound digital lead channel.

Timeline: Figma wireframes → Shopify live in **2 weeks**

Booking Form Optimisation (Post-Launch)

After launch, GA funnel analysis revealed a **38% mobile abandonment rate at the date-picker step.**

Hypothesis: The date-picker was unnecessary friction — the sales team collected preferred dates during WhatsApp follow-up anyway. Removing it wouldn't reduce lead quality.

Change: Simplified from complex multi-field form → **4 fields only** (Name, Phone, Service Required, Location). Mobile-first design, larger tap targets, no dropdowns.

Measurement period: 4 weeks post-change using GA + Shopify analytics + Excel tracking.

Results

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Monthly inbound leads     20  →  70       +250%  (3.5×)
Weekly form submissions    5–7 →  12–18   +150%  (2.5×)
Lead-to-paid-job conv.    Unknown → 60%
Repeat customer retention Unknown → ~40%
Time to launch            0  →  Live in 2 weeks
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Why 60% conversion?

Customers who found us via the website already knew the approximate price, had seen the trust signals, and had read about our brand partners. The sales conversation started from a position of established credibility — not cold outreach.

North Star Metric

> ***Qualified inquiries converting to booked jobs per month***

Weekly review cadence tracking across AARRR stages:

- **Acquisition:** Organic search traffic, JustDial referral decline
- **Activation:** Form completion rate, 'Book a Meet' submissions
- **Retention:** Repeat inquiry rate, WhatsApp follow-up response rate

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Key Learnings

1. **Solve the full journey, not the obvious step.** The brief was "build a website." The real product was a complete digital + operational system. Solving just the website would have created more inquiries hitting a broken process.
2. **Trust is a product decision, not a design decision.** Showing pricing, credentials, and project counts wasn't branding — it was the direct answer to what user research said was stopping conversion.
3. **Small UX fixes can have outsized impact.** One date-picker removal → 2.5× form submissions. The diagnostic instinct matters more than the fix itself.

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